



Grade 1 Language Arts

OPTIMA ACADEMY ONLINE · FAMILY COURSE OVERVIEW · GRADE 1 · FULL YEAR

~12½ hrs per week · 150 min/day, M–F

About this overview. This document is an example of how the course might be taught. This overview is drawn from the Florida course description and Optima's 2026–27 course plan rather than a fully built course, so scholars may see some variation in texts, activities, and projects from course to course, and between the live school and On-Demand. Each teacher also leans into their own strengths and passions; the structure, expectations, and time commitment below are representative of the course as designed.

In Grade 1 Language Arts, scholars build foundational phonics and comprehension skills, explore rich stories and informational texts, and express their ideas through speaking and writing with clarity and creativity. Explicit, systematic phonics anchors the year, while classically sound instruction deepens understanding and engagement. Background knowledge grows across domains as scholars read a balance of literary and informational texts.

THE YEAR AT A GLANCE

1 Foundational Skills (Phonics & Fluency) (strand)

Phonological awareness, grade-level phonics and word analysis, sight words, and reading with accuracy and prosody; locating book features (ELA.1.F).

3 Communication (Writing, Speaking & Conventions) (strand)

Writing narrative, opinion, and expository pieces from a source; oral presentation; grade-level grammar; research and digital tools (ELA.1.C).

5 Expectations: Reasoning & Discussion (foundation)

Citing evidence, comprehending grade-level texts, making inferences, and justifying thinking in academic conversation (ELA.K12.EE).

2 Reading: Prose, Poetry & Informational Texts (strand)

Story elements, moral of a story, narrator, and poem structure; text features, topic and details, and comparing texts (ELA.1.R).

4 Vocabulary & Word Knowledge (strand)

Academic vocabulary, base words and inflections, and context and picture clues to determine word meaning (ELA.1.V).

A TYPICAL WEEK

- Daily foundational skills: phonics, word analysis, sight words, and reading fluency.
- Reading aloud and shared reading of stories and informational texts, with talk about story elements, topics, and details.
- Vocabulary and language work, building academic words and background knowledge.
- Writing connected to the reading across narrative, opinion, and expository forms, plus regular practice and check-ins.

TIME COMMITMENT

750 minutes / week

≈ 2½ hours a day, Monday–Friday

- A typical day blends foundational skills, read-alouds and shared reading, oral language, and writing.
- Texts are split roughly 50% literary and 50% informational, as the Florida course expects.
- Scheduled time also supports fluency practice, oral discussion, and regular check-ins.

WHAT SCHOLARS NEED

- Read-aloud and decodable or leveled books (home, library, or school-provided).
- A notebook or writing journal, pencil, and paper.
- A computer with reliable internet and access to Canvas.
- An adult to support read-alouds and emerging readers (especially in Kindergarten).

On-Demand (asynchronous). Scholars move through the course at their own pace, with due dates to keep the year on track. An Optima teacher is available throughout for support, feedback, and grading.

Live school. Live-school scholars take this same course on Optima's VR campus with a teacher and classmates, meeting daily as a core course.